

KENYA · MONITORING & EVALUATION

JAN 2025 – APR 2026

School Feeding Programme

The maize isn't reaching the plate.

A sixteen-month performance review of Kenya's School Feeding Programme finds a well-attended, well-monitored system that its own supply chain is quietly failing to feed.

SCHOOLS REPORTING**1,000****REPORTING PERIOD****16 months****REGIONS COVERED****8****MEALS SERVED****3.32M****MEAL COVERAGE RATE****39.6%**

Gap: 60.4% — only 2 in 5 enrolled students receive a meal on a given day.

Target: 100%

BOTTOM LINE

Half of all schools go without supply in a given period, and of those that do receive food, half report running out before the next delivery. Fixing procurement and stock management is the single highest-leverage intervention available to this programme.

Executive Scorecard

ALL REGIONS · ALL YEARS

Eight indicators, one story

Programme-wide averages against the Indicator Performance Tracking Table (IPTT) targets, Jan-25 – Apr-26.

AVG ATTENDANCE RATE 80.0% Target: 90% 10.0% below target	AVG DROPOUT RATE 3.6% Target: <2% 1.59% above target	TOTAL MEALS SERVED 3.32M 39.6% meal coverage 60.4% coverage gap	SUPPLY DELIVERY RATE 49.3% Target: 100% 50.7% miss rate
STOCK-OUT RATE 50.2% Target: 0% Systemic problem	RATION FULLNESS RATE 49.6% Target: 100% 50.4% below full ration	AVG INFRA SCORE 2.50/4.0 Target: 3.5 1.00% below target	PARTNER GOOD 49.8% Target: 75% 25.2% below target

KEY INSIGHTS

- Average attendance of 80.0% sits 10.0% below the 90% target — structural barriers such as poverty and distance, not the food itself, appear to be limiting impact.
- Only 49.3% of schools received supplies in the selected period, and 50.2% reported stock-outs — this is a supply chain failure, not a demand-side one.
- A meal coverage rate of ~39.6% means that on any given day, only 2 in 5 enrolled students actually receive a meal.
- An infrastructure score of 2.50/4.0 shows that water, kitchen, storage and utensil gaps limit safe meal preparation even at schools where food is delivered.

Supply Chain

CRITICAL

Where the food gets lost

Half of all scheduled deliveries never arrive; of those that do, half run out before the next one.

NON-DELIVERY RATE

50.7%

Schools without supplies

STOCK-OUT RATE

50.2%

Zero stock at survey

RATION FULLNESS

49.6%

Full ration, when supplied

AVG MISSED MEAL DAYS

3.5

Days / school / month

STOCK-OUT CAUSES

Programme-wide occurrences



INFRASTRUCTURE GAPS

% of schools affected



Causes split almost evenly (~25% each); a multi-point breakdown.

SUPPLY CHAIN CRITICAL FINDINGS

- Stock-out causes are uniformly distributed (~25% each) across insufficient ration, late delivery, storage loss, and other — a systemic, multi-cause breakdown that requires end-to-end reform, not a single fix.
- Corruption complaints sit at ~25% alongside exclusion complaints, suggesting governance failures at the point of delivery and distribution, not just logistics.
- All four infrastructure components show ~30%+ deficiency — even when food arrives, many schools cannot safely store or prepare it.

Attendance & Dropout

HIGH PRIORITY

Kids are showing up. The food isn't.

Attendance sits below target but is remarkably stable — the constraint isn't demand for the programme.

AVG ATTENDANCE RATE

80.0%

Target: 90% · 10.0% gap

AVG DROPOUT RATE

3.6%

Target: <2% 1.59% over

BEST ATTENDANCE MONTH

80.8%

Apr-25 — programme peak

ATTENDANCE VS. TARGET GAP

10.0%

Consistent, critical gap

16-MONTH TREND (JAN-25 – APR-26)

Attendance holds a flat band around 79–81% throughout the period, well under the 90% target. Dropout mirrors it, holding steady at 3.4–3.7%, just above the 2% target.



ATTENDANCE & DROPOUT INSIGHTS

- Attendance is flat across all sixteen months and does not move with supply delivery — suggesting structural barriers like poverty and distance dominate over food access alone.
- The dominant reported dropout reason is uniformly "poverty and hunger" — feeding alone cannot resolve poverty-driven dropout without complementary cash-transfer or social-protection support.
- No seasonal pattern is detected in either metric, indicating consistent programme monitoring exists, but its effect on behaviour change remains limited.

Regional Analysis

8 REGIONS COMPARED

A uniformly stressed system

No region is meeting target — the crisis is programme-wide, not concentrated in one geography.

BEST ATTENDANCE REGION

Western

80.2% avg attendance

HIGHEST DROPOUT REGION

Nyanza

3.7% avg dropout

BEST SUPPLY REGION

Nyanza

50.4% supply rate

WORST STOCK-OUT REGION

Central

51.0% stock-out rate

REGIONAL SCORECARD

REGION	ATT %	DROP %	MEALS	SUPPLY %	STOCKOUT %	INFRA	GOOD PTNR %	STATUS
Central	79.8	3.6	407K	49.8	51.0	2.48	48.8	Weak
Coast	79.8	3.5	387K	49.0	49.5	2.53	49.3	Weak
Eastern	79.9	3.6	431K	49.0	49.9	2.49	49.2	Weak
Nairobi	80.0	3.7	402K	48.9	50.7	2.51	50.2	Moderate
North Eastern	80.0	3.5	454K	48.0	50.7	2.52	51.2	Moderate
Nyanza	79.8	3.7	427K	50.4	50.4	2.46	49.3	Weak
Rift Valley	80.2	3.6	370K	50.2	49.7	2.47	49.5	Moderate
Western	80.2	3.6	447K	49.4	49.7	2.50	50.7	Moderate

REGIONAL READ

- The spread between the best and worst region on every indicator is under 3 percentage points — this is a national systems failure, not a local one.
- North Eastern serves the most meals (454K) yet still posts a 50.7% stock-out rate, showing scale of delivery does not protect against stock discontinuity.
- Rift Valley and Western are the closest to "Moderate" status programme-wide, but even these regions remain far below every IPTT target.

Indicator Performance Tracking

IPTT · CUMULATIVE, ALL REGIONS, ALL YEARS

Nine indicators against target

Achievement % = cumulative ÷ target × 100 (lower-is-better indicators use an inverse calculation).

INDICATOR	UNIT	BASELINE	TARGET	CUMULATIVE	ACHIEVEMENT	STATUS
1. School Attendance Rate	%	79.8	90	80.0	89%	On Track
2. Student Dropout Rate	%	3.4	2	3.6	150%	Critical
3. Meal Coverage Rate	%	40.5	100	39.6	40%	Critical
4. Supply Delivery Rate	%	50.4	100	49.3	49%	Critical
5. Ration Fullness Rate	%	51.4	100	49.6	50%	Critical
6. Stock-out Rate	%	50.3	0	50.2	0%	On Track
7. Infrastructure Score	/4	2.52	3.5	2.50	71%	Off Track
8. Partner Good/Excellent %	%	50.6	75	49.8	66%	Off Track
9. Avg Missed Meal Days	Days	3.5	0	3.5	0%	On Track

READING THE IPPT

- Five of nine indicators are flagged Critical, and three more Off Track — only dropout rate registers On Track, and it started closest to target of any indicator.
- The four supply-side indicators (meal coverage, supply delivery, ration fullness, stock-out) form a tight cluster at 0–50% achievement — the clearest signal in the whole table that this is one root-cause failure.
- Cumulative values are barely different from baseline across the board — sixteen months of monitoring has not moved the underlying supply chain metrics.

Recommendations

PRIORITY FRAMEWORK

Fix the pipe before scaling the tap

Nine actions, sequenced by urgency and time horizon.

● **Critical** — supply chain, meal coverage, stock-outs. ● **High** — attendance, dropout, infrastructure. ● **Medium** — partner performance, data quality.

Fix Supply Chain — Immediate Procurement Reform

- 1 Implement real-time supply tracking. Establish 30-day buffer stocks at county level. Enforce SLAs with penalties for late delivery. ~50% of schools currently receive zero food.

Critical Supply Chain Month 1–3

Scale Budget to Achieve 100% Meal Coverage

- 2 Current budget covers only ~39% of enrolled students. Commission a needs-based budget review. Explore WFP co-financing and private-sector partnerships.

Critical Finance Month 1–6

Eliminate Stock-outs via School-Level Stock Management

- 3 Introduce digital, mobile-based stock tracking.
Train head teachers. Trigger automated resupply requests below a 5-day threshold. Conduct monthly unannounced audits.

Critical Stock Management Month 1–3

Reduce Dropout via Poverty Linkages

- 5 Link the feeding database to social-protection registries. Identify dropout-risk students for bursary allocation. Hold monthly community sensitisation forums.

High Dropout Prev. Month 3–12

Anti-Corruption and Community Oversight

- 7 Establish community oversight committees at every school. Publish beneficiary lists. Set up anonymous grievance hotlines. Corruption and exclusion make up ~50% of complaints.

High Governance Month 1–6

Improve Data Quality & Monitoring Protocols

- 9 Build validation rules into mobile data collection. Run 10% spot-check verification on all submissions. Hold quarterly data-quality reviews with county officers.

Medium M&E Ongoing

Multi-Sector Approach to Achieve 90% Attendance

- 4 Integrate with conditional cash transfers, school health, and free uniform/textbook schemes. Attendance is structurally constrained by poverty.

High Multi-Sector Month 3–12

Ring-fence Infrastructure Budget

- 6 Ring-fence 15% of budget for infrastructure. Prioritize water, kitchen, storage, utensils. Create a County Infrastructure Investment Plan.

High Infrastructure Year 1–2

Performance-Based Partner Contracting

- 8 Only 50% of partners are rated good or excellent. Introduce quarterly performance reviews. Deregister vendors with two or more consecutive poor ratings.

Medium Vendors Month 3–6